AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION



The Proving Grounds

CTF Practice, Labs & Hacking Training

74	120,173	43%	14
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 438 curated free tools across 14 realms.

CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

74	32	120,173	14	1,366	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Hack legally — wargames, CTF platforms and deliberately-vulnerable apps to sharpen your skills.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Proving Grounds CTF practice and hacking training ecosystem is mature, with 74 free tools (32 hosted on GitHub) boasting 120,173 combined stars, reflecting a well-established field of cybersecurity training resources. Star distribution shows long-standing tools like DVWA (13.8k stars, 2013) and pwntools (13.8k stars, 2013) lead, indicating sustained demand for foundational, versatile training assets over newer entries. A notable trend is the consolidation of popular, multi-purpose tools—such as pwntools spanning binary exploitation and OWASP Juice Shop for web app testing—reducing the need for disjointed niche resources.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX (GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES)



● MIT **9** ● Apache-2.0 **5** ● GPL **11** ● Other/none **7**

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2010**; the youngest joined in **2022**. **14/32** GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the remainder are stable classics or web services rather than abandoned picks.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS



QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

Metasploitable 3, HEVD, APTSimulator, OWASP NodeGoat, XVWA, flightsim, DIVA Android, DVIA-v2, AzureGoat, DVWS (Web Services), WackoPicko, 0l4bs, lfi-labs, Hackademic, DVHMA, CryptOMG, damnvulnerable.me, SentinelTestbed

02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

01 Vulhub

github.com/vulhub/vulhub

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 21.4k	4.8k	2017
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**MIT**	**Dockerfile**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Pre-Built Vulnerable Environments Based on Docker-Compose"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

dockerized vulnerable environments: spin up a CVE, test, tear down.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9 yrs	4819	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 OWASP Juice Shop

github.com/juice-shop/juice-shop

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 14.1k GITHUB STARS	20.1k FORKS	2014 FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10 LAST PUSH	MIT LICENSE	TypeScript LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1



THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Juice Shop: Probably the most modern and sophisticated insecure web application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the modern deliberately-vulnerable app with gamified challenges covering the whole OWASP spectrum.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12 yrs YEARS ON GITHUB	20078 FORKS (REUSE)	— OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 DVWA

github.com/digininja/DVWA

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 13.8k GITHUB STARS	5.2k FORKS	2013 FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10 LAST PUSH	GPL-3.0 LICENSE	PHP LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Web Application (DVWA)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic Damn Vulnerable Web Application for safely learning injection basics.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13 yrs YEARS ON GITHUB	5204 FORKS (REUSE)	— OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 pwntools

github.com/Gallopsled/pwntools

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 13.8k	1.9k	2013
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-09	**NOASSERTION**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTF framework and exploit development library"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the CTF exploit-development library: from sockets to ROP chains, pwn everything.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13 yrs	1864	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 WebGoat

github.com/WebGoat/WebGoat

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 9.4k	8.1k	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**NOASSERTION**	**JavaScript**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WebGoat is a deliberately insecure application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

OWASP's teaching app: guided lessons with a solution walkthrough for each vulnerability class.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	8079	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 GOAD

github.com/Orange-Cyberdefense/GOAD

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

ACTIVE 2026

★ 8.5k	1.2k	2021
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-03	**GPL-3.0**	**PowerShell**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"game of active directory"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Game of Active Directory: a three-forest lab purpose-built for safely practicing AD attack techniques.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



5 yrs	1166	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #6 by adoption

07 CTFd

github.com/CTFd/CTFd

ACTIVE 2026

★ 6.9k	2.8k	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**Apache-2.0**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTFs as you need them"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the CTF platform that powers thousands of events; self-host your own competition.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	2768	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #7 by adoption

08 Metasploitable 3

github.com/rapid7/metasploitable3

★ 5.7k	1.3k	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2025-02	**NOASSERTION**	**HTML**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Metasploitable3 is a VM that is built from the ground up with a large amount of security vulnerabilities."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Rapid7's purpose-built vulnerable target VM; the canonical Metasploit practice range.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	1272	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #8 by adoption

09 CloudGoat

github.com/RhinoSecurityLabs/cloudgoat

ACTIVE 2026

★ 3.8k	774	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**BSD-3-Clause**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CloudGoat is Rhino Security Labs' "Vulnerable by Design" AWS deployment tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Rhino Security's "vulnerable by design" AWS scenarios — deploy, attack, tear down.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	774	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #9 by adoption

10 HEVD

github.com/hacksysteam/HackSysExtremeVulnerableDriver

★ 3.1k	586	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2025-02	**GPL-3.0**	**C**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"HackSys Extreme Vulnerable Driver (HEVD) - Windows & Linux"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Windows kernel-driver training target for exploit development.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	586	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #10 by adoption

11 APTSimulator

github.com/NextronSystems/APTSimulator

★ 2.8k	453	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2025-09	**MIT**	**Batchfile**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A toolset to make a system look as if it was the victim of an APT attack"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

makes a Windows host look compromised so you can test detections safely.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	453	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #11 by adoption

12 Splunk Attack Range

github.com/splunk/attack_range

ACTIVE 2026

★ 2.6k	418	2019
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-10	**Apache-2.0**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A tool that allows you to create vulnerable instrumented local or cloud environments to simulate attacks against and collect the data into Splunk "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

builds instrumented detection labs: attack, collect and test in one workflow.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



7 yrs	418	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #12 by adoption

13 OWASP NodeGoat

github.com/OWASP/NodeGoat

★ 2.1k	3.0k	2013
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2024-06	**Apache-2.0**	**HTML**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The OWASP NodeGoat project provides an environment to learn how OWASP Top 10 security risks apply to web applications developed using Node.js and how to effectively address them."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Node.js vulnerable-by-design app: the Top 10 in a controllable lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13 yrs	3027	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #13 by adoption

14 XVWA

github.com/s4n7h0/xvwa

ARCHIVED

★ 1.8k	364	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2020-09	**GPL-3.0**	**PHP**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"XVWA is a badly coded web application written in PHP/MySQL that helps security enthusiasts to learn application security. "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Xtreme Vulnerable Web Application: dozens of flaws across one PHP app.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	364	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #14 by adoption

15 OWASP Mutillidae II

github.com/webpwnized/mutillidae

ACTIVE 2026

★ 1.5k	566	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-09	**GPL-3.0**	**PHP**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Mutillidae II is a free, open-source, deliberately vulnerable web application providing a target for web-security training. This is an easy-to-use web hacking environment designed for labs, security enthusiasts, classrooms, CTF, and vulnerability assessment tool targets."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

deliberately vulnerable app that re-creates every OWASP Top 10 issue, resettable per install.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	566	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #15 by adoption

16 flightsim

github.com/alphasoc/flightsim

★ 1.4k	144	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2024-04	**NOASSERTION**	**Go**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A utility to safely generate malicious network traffic patterns and evaluate controls."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

generates malicious network traffic for IDS/NDR validation; defender-side only. (CC-BY-4.0)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	144	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #16 by adoption

17 DIVA Android

github.com/payatu/diva-android

★ 1.2k	332	2016
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2023-05	**GPL-3.0**	**Java**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"DIVA Android - Damn Insecure and vulnerable App for Android"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Insecure and Vulnerable App: the Android training classic.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10 yrs	332	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #17 by adoption

18 DVIA-v2

github.com/prateek147/DVIA-v2

★ 1.1k	244	2018
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2024-03	**MIT**	**Swift**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable iOS App (DVIA) is an iOS application that is damn vulnerable. Its main goal is to provide a platform to mobile security enthusiasts/professionals or students to test their iOS penetration testing skills in a legal environment. This project is developed and maintained by @prateekg147."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Vulnerable iOS App v2: the mobile testing curriculum as an app.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8 yrs	244	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #18 by adoption

19 AzureGoat

github.com/ine-labs/AzureGoat

★ 967	258	2022
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2024-10	**MIT**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"AzureGoat : A Damn Vulnerable Azure Infrastructure"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable-by-design Azure cloud lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



4 yrs	258	—	quiet
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #19 by adoption

20 DSVW

github.com/stamparm/DSVW

ACTIVE 2026

★ 882	380	2015
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED
2026-08	**Unlicense**	**Python**
LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

star weight vs realm #1

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Small Vulnerable Web"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Small Vulnerable Web: the Top 10 in ~100 lines of Python. (public domain)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11 yrs	380	—	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #20 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists

half-page dossiers · 100+ stars each

The realm's mid-tier: proven, community-adopted tools that either power specific niches or are climbing fast. Same live-census treatment — two profiles per page.

02 Rising Stars & Specialists

two full dossiers per page - live census

21 Vulnerable Node

github.com/cr0hn/vulnerable-node

ACTIVE 2026

★ 493	774	2016	2026-10	NOASSERTION	JavaScript
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Vulnerable Nodejs — a real shop (NodeBazaar) intentionally full of security bugs. 14 labs, OWASP Top 10:2025, SAST benchmark. Node.js port of DVWA."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Node.js vulnerable application for testing analysis tools.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #21 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

22 DVWS (Web Services)

github.com/snoopysecurity/dvws

ARCHIVED

★ 461	137	2016	2021-12	Apache-2.0	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Web Services is an insecure web application with multiple vulnerable web service components that can be used to learn real world web service vulnerabilities. NOTE: This project is out of date, please use https://github.com/snoopysecurity/dvws-node"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

vulnerable web services for SOA/API security practice.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #22 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

23 DVWS (Web Sockets)

github.com/interference-security/DVWS

ACTIVE 2026

★ 363	80	2017	2026-07	MIT	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWSAP Damn Vulnerable Web Sockets (DVWS) is a vulnerable web application which works on web sockets for client-server communication."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable WebSocket app from Interference Security.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #23 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

24 WackoPicko

github.com/adamdoupe/WackoPicko

★ 354	231	2010	2024-05	MIT	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WackoPicko is a vulnerable web application used to test web application vulnerability scanners."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable app built for testing vulnerability scanners — a frozen-by-design calibration target for your tooling.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #24 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

25 0l4bs

github.com/tegal1337/0l4bs

★ 350	48	2020	2021-06	GPL-3.0	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Cross-site scripting labs for web application security enthusiasts "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

XSS practice labs with progressive difficulty.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #25 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

26 lfi-labs

github.com/paralax/lfi-labs

★ 335	84	2015	2024-04	MIT	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"small set of PHP scripts to practice exploiting LFI, RFI and CMD injection vulns"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

LFI/RFI/commix practice pages: one flaw family, many variants.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #26 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

27 Hackademic

github.com/Hackademic/hackademic

ARCHIVED

★ 325	116	2012	2020-10	GPL-3.0	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"the main hackademic code repository"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

WordPress-based vulnerable lab scenarios for classroom use.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #27 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

28 Java Vulnerable Lab

github.com/CSPF-Founder/JavaVulnerableLab

ACTIVE 2026

★ 278	534	2015	2026-10	GPL-2.0	Java
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Vulnerable Java based Web Application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Java vulnerable web application from the CSPF crew.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #28 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

29 DVHMA

github.com/logicalhacking/DVHMA

★ 274	63	2015	2018-08	Apache-2.0	JavaScript
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Hybrid Mobile App (DVHMA) is an hybrid mobile app (for Android) that intentionally contains vulnerabilities. "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Damn Vulnerable Hybrid Mobile App: Android+iOS appsec in one codebase.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #29 by adoption

02 Rising Stars & Specialists - continued

two full dossiers per page - live census

30 CryptOMG

github.com/SpiderLabs/CryptOMG

★ 195	54	2012	2015-06	GPL-3.0	PHP
GITHUB STARS	FORKS	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CryptOMG is a configurable CTF style test bed that highlights common flaws in cryptographic implementations."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

cryptographic flaw testbed from SpiderLabs.

GitHub presence: **verified — live stats**

The Proving Grounds · realm rank #30 by adoption

03 Full Inventory

74 entries · every curated tool

Every entry from the heaven list, carrying its live census chips: stars, first release, 2026 activity, license and language. Rising stars and web-native services included.

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services

every curated entry - live census chips

damnvulnerable.me

★ 34 · since 2015 · MIT · HTML

a modern vulnerable webapp for the OWASP Top 10 era.

github.com/skepticfx/damnvulnerable.me

SentinelTestbed

★ 11 · since 2013 · GPL-3.0 · PHP

a testbed app for evaluating security instrumentation.

github.com/dobin/SentinelTestbed

Hack The Box

free tier

the platform for ranked machines, pro labs and active-dir ranges; the industry's proving ground.

hackthebox.com

TryHackMe

free tier

guided rooms from your first command to advanced red/blue paths — the friendliest on-ramp.

tryhackme.com

picoCTF

CMU's beginner-friendly CTF — the best first flag anyone can capture.

picoctf.org

OverTheWire

Bandit and friends: learn Linux, networking and protocols through SSH wargames.

overthewire.org

VulnHub

downloadable vulnerable VMs; build and break your own home lab offline.

vulnhub.com

CTFtime

the global CTF calendar, team rankings and writeup index — the hub of the sport.

ctftime.org

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services - continued

every curated entry - live census chips

Cryptopals

the legendary crypto challenges; finish them and AES is no longer magic.

cryptopals.com

Gandalf

Lakera's free prompt-injection game; learn AI-security attacks hands-on, level by level.

gandalf.lakera.ai

bWAPP

the "buggy web application" with 100+ vulnerability flavors — an old-school playground that still teaches.

itsecgames.com/

Root Me

free tier

hundreds of real-world hacking challenges across dozens of categories, from web to stego.

root-me.org/

Google Gruyere

Google's cheese-themed vulnerable web app: exploit XSS, XSRF and information disclosure in the cloud.

google-gruyere.appspot.com/

CryptoHack

learn modern cryptography by breaking it: challenges from classical ciphers to ECC.

cryptohack.org/

Hackxor

a realistic web-app hacking game with a story arc — WebGoat with sharper teeth.

hackxor.net/

CyberDefenders

free tier

blue-team CTF platform: investigate realistic incidents with the tools a SOC actually uses.

cyberdefenders.org/

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services - continued

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LetsDefend

free tier

browser-based SOC simulator: alert queues, playbooks and IR challenges mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.

letsdefend.io/

pwnable.kr

the classic system-hacking wargame: exploit your way from userland to kernel.

pwnable.kr/

Hack This Site

the community wargames veteran: missions, articles and forums since the early 2000s.

hackthissite.org/

Pentest-Ground

free service

hosted practice playground of intentionally vulnerable apps for security testing.

pentest-ground.com/

testasp.vulnweb.com

free service

the ASP demo target for scanner testing.

testasp.vulnweb.com/

testaspnet.vulnweb.com

free service

the ASP.NET demo target for scanner testing.

testaspnet.vulnweb.com/

Zero Bank

free service

demo banking site for web security exercises.

zero.webappsecurity.com/

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services - continued

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Altoro Mutual

free service

the classic demo bank: legal target for appsec training and tool demos.

demo.testfire.net/

Firing Range

Apache-2.0

Google's XSS testbed: the original scanner benchmarking target.

public-firing-range.appspot.com/

XSS Game

free service

Google's XSS tutorial game: six levels from context basics to DOM tricks.

xss-game.appspot.com/

Arizona Cyber Warfare Range

free service

free live-fire ranges for defenders and researchers.

azcwr.org/az-cyber-warfare-ranges

SocketToMe

free service

Robin Wood's WebSocket testing challenge app.

digi.ninja/projects/sockettome.php

techlogia Lab

free browser-based hacking lab for security training. (CC-BY-4.0)

techlogia.de/en/lab

Crackmes.one

free service

the reverse-engineering challenge community: thousands of crackmes, all legal.

crackmes.one/

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services - continued

every curated entry - live census chips

Microcorruption

free service

embedded-security CTF: reverse the lock firmware, level by level.

microcorruption.com/

MASTG Crackmes

the mobile RE challenges companion to the OWASP MASTG. (CC-BY-SA-4.0)

github.com/OWASP/mastg/tree/master/Crackmes

Reversing.kr

free service

the classic Korean reverse-engineering challenge site.

reversing.kr

Vulnserver

free service

the TCP vulnerable server for exploit-dev practice.

thegreycorner.com/2010/12/introducing-vulnserver.html

CTFlearn

free service

the beginner-friendly CTF platform with a permanent challenge set.

ctflearn.com/

Hackertest.net

free service

the 20-level hacking simulation for web basics.

hackertest.net/

HackThis!!

free service

50+ levels of web security challenges, from basics to advanced.

hackthis.co.uk/

03 Full Inventory - rising stars & services - continued

every curated entry - live census chips

MysteryTwister C3

free service

the international cryptography challenge: from Caesar to quantum.

mysterytwisterc3.org/en/

RingZer0 CTF

free service

hundreds of challenges across web, crypto, forensics and reversing.

ringzer0ctf.com/

SmashTheStack

free service

the wargames network: shellcoding, exploitation and logic puzzles.

smashthestack.org/

W3Challs

free service

pentest training challenges with a ranking system.

w3challs.com

WeChall

free service

the challenge-site aggregator: one profile across all major wargames.

wechall.net/

ExploitMe Mobile

free service

the SecurityCompass mobile labs.

securitycompass.github.io/AndroidLabs/index.html

OWASP iGoat

wiki project

the iOS learning app from the OWASP mobile family.

wiki.owasp.org/index.php/OWASP_iGoat_Tool_Project

04 Realm Directory

74 curated entries · A–Z

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- Java Vulnerable Lab
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- OWASP iGoat
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- Reversing.kr
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- Splunk Attack Range
- testasp.vulnweb.com
- TryHackMe
- Vulnerable Node
- Vulnserver
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- XVWA
- Altoro Mutual
- Arizona Cyber Warfare Range
- bWAPP
- Crackmes.one
- CryptOMG
- CTFd
- CTFtime
- damnvulnerable.me
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- ExploitMe Mobile
- flightsim
- GOAD
- Hack The Box
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- OWASP Juice Shop
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- Zero Bank

FEATURED PRODUCT — BY THE HEAVEN CURATOR

2MNY Website Vulnerability Scanner

Self-hosted website protection suite with 280+ deterministic scanner modules — OWASP Top 10, WordPress/CMS deep scans, subdomain takeover, AI-stack exposure, CVSS evidence reports. The production platform that curates this heaven list.